

BRANCH ADVISORY COUNCIL

INTRODUCTORY REMARKS

Wednesday, 23 April 2025



BRANCH APPOINTMENTS

PRESENTED BY BRANCH ADVISOR

Wednesday, 23 April 2025



STARTING APS25

- ▶ Branch Affairs Officer - LCol - Class A - Vacant (Candidate Identified)
- ▶ Branch 125th LCol - LCol - Class A - Vacant (Position approved - being created in Guardian / Aim for position start post C&E Week 2025)
- ▶ Branch Adjutant - **Major Emilie Circe**
- ▶ Branch Bandmaster - Vacant
- ▶ Branch Chief Clerk - Sgt - Class B - Vacant

C&E WEEK 2025

PRESENTED BY BRANCH ADVISOR

Wednesday, 23 April 2025



C&E WEEK - AAR 2024

► Improve

- Accuracy of information on CMCEN. **Site pages will be drafted in August and go live in early September.**
- Conflicting priorities for OPIs. **Task Units, not people**
- Overwhelming schedule impacted participation. **Decouple CTF and Ex COMM PLAYER from C&E Week**
- Low participation at Subbies and Sgts Indoc, potentially due to duplicate trg received during DP1 (subbies) and DP3 (Sgts). **Replace Subbies and Sgts Indoc with townhalls**
- CFSCE does not have sufficient equipment to support Ex NS during first 24hrs of competition. **Task 8 ACCS with Ex NOBLE SKYWAVE (frequent winners)**
- No significant activity planning conducted prior to Sep cause late release of information. **Create planning timeline**
- Single mess dinner resulted in capacity being reached just prior to event, and too late to split mess dinner into two. **Start with two mess dinners and combine if required.**

► Sustain

- RoC Drill with OPIs clarified information
- Split between NCR and KGN enabled higher participation (CFS Leitrim ARM was a good venue)
- General Instruction early, Detailed Instruction later
- Jr Ranks Dinner had high participation and great questions. Encourage Kingston-based Comd Teams to participate.

C&E WEEK 2025

- ▶ Planning Timeline
 - ▶ IPC - May
 - ▶ MPC - early August
 - ▶ RoC Drill - late August
 - ▶ Backbrief - Fall BAC
 - ▶ FCC - early October
- ▶ COAs (common to all - remove Ex COMM PLAYER and Subbies/Sgts Indoc)
 - ▶ COA 1 - All in Kingston
 - ▶ COA 2 - Split NCR and Kingston
 - ▶ COA 3 - Split NCR and Kingston, plus regional PD/Super Jimmy Day

C&E Week COA 1 - Consolidated

Intent: Host all activities in Kingston, while providing virtual presence. SoM: Start with PD-focus items before moving into RCCS/RCAF activities and finishing with ceremonial. ME: 24 Oct 25 activities. End State: Increased Kingston participation.

Day	Monday	Tuesday	Wednesday	Thursday	Friday	Saturday/Sunday
OCTOBER	20	21	22	23	24	26
Host Location (Alternate)	Kingston	Kingston	Kingston	Kingston	Kingston	Kingston
Concurrent Event		EX NOBLE SKYWAVE				
Morning	Opening Remarks Branch Leadership Address Keynote	Association PD	RCCS Conf CAPCON Branch Leadership Townhall (Subalterns)	RCCS Conf CAPCON	Veteran's Day (Carruthers')	ARes Conference
Afternoon	CANSOF / CJOC / Army G6 / RCAF A6 Break Home Station / Association / Foundation	Association PD +AGM	RCCS Conf CAPCON Branch Leadership Townhall (Sr NCOs)	C&E Senate	Branch Update / Occ Adv Update Break Honours and Recognition / Ex NS and CTF Winner Announcement	ARes Conference
Evening	C&E Branch Meet and Greet	Retired Generals Meeting	Jr Ranks Dinner (plus townhall)	TGIT (VOM)	Officer Mess Dinner NCM Mess Dinner	

Adv: - Simplified Logistics

Disadv: - Less inclusive for participation
- Higher cost (\$28k)

C&E Week COA 2 - Split

Intent: Activities split between NCR and Kingston, plus virtual presence. SoM: Start with PD-focus items before moving into RCCS/RCAF activities and finishing with ceremonial. ME: 24 Oct 25 activities. End State: Increased NCR and Kingston participation.

Day	Monday	Tuesday	Wednesday	Thursday	Friday	Saturday/Sunday
OCTOBER	20	21	22	23	24	26
Host Location (Alternate)	NCR	NCR	Kingston	Kingston	Kingston	Kingston
Concurrent Event		EX NOBLE SKYWAVE				
Morning	Opening Remarks Branch Leadership Address Keynote	Association PD	RCCS Conf CAPCON Branch Leadership Townhall (Subalterns)	RCCS Conf CAPCON	Veteran's Day (Carruthers')	ARes Conference
Afternoon	CANSOF / CJOC / Army G6 / RCAF A6 Break Home Station / Association / Foundation	Association PD +AGM	RCCS Conf CAPCON Branch Leadership Townhall (Sr NCOs)	C&E Senate	Branch Update / Occ Adv Update Break Honours and Recognition / Ex NS and CTF Winner Announcement	ARes Conference
Evening	C&E Branch Meet and Greet	Retired Generals Meeting	Jr Ranks Dinner (plus townhall)	TGIT (VOM)	Officer Mess Dinner NCM Mess Dinner	

Adv: - Inclusive of NCR and Kingston
- Lower cost (\$26k)

Disadv: - More logistically complex

C&E Week COA 3 - Distributed

Intent: Activities split between NCR and Kingston, with one day distributed, plus virtual presence. SoM: Start with PD-focus items before moving into RCCS/RCAF activities and finishing with ceremonial. ME: 24 Oct 25 activities. End State: Increased Canada-wide participation.

Day	Monday	Tuesday	Wednesday	Thursday	Friday	Saturday/Sunday
OCTOBER	20	21	22	23	24	26
Host Location (Alternate)	NCR	NCR	Kingston	Kingston	Kingston / Regional	Kingston
Concurrent Event		EX NOBLE SKYWAVE				
Morning	Opening Remarks Branch Leadership Address Keynote	Association PD	RCCS Conf CAPCON Branch Leadership Townhall (Subalterns)	RCCS Conf CAPCON	Veteran's Day (Carruthers') Regional PD and Super Jimmy Day (ATL, QC, WST, PAC)	ARes Conference
Afternoon	CANSOF / CJOC / Army G6 / RCAF A6 Break Home Station / Association / Foundation	Association PD +AGM	RCCS Conf CAPCON Branch Leadership Townhall (Sr NCOs)	C&E Senate	Branch Update / Occ Adv Update Break Honours and Recognition / Ex NS and CTF Winner Announcement	ARes Conference
Evening	C&E Branch Meet and Greet	Retired Generals Meeting	Jr Ranks Dinner (plus townhall)	TGIT (VOM)	Officer Mess Dinner NCM Mess Dinner	

Adv: - Inclusive of Canada-wide participation
- Low cost (\$26k)

Disadv: - Most complex (coordination and logistics)

BRANCH AMBASSADOR PROGRAM

PRESENTED BY BRANCH CHIEF

Wednesday, 23 April 2025



STRATEGIC J6 DISCUSSION

PRESENTED BY MGEN (RETD)
DAVE NEASMITH

Wednesday, 23 April 2025





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DIGITAL SERVICES GROUP

Dave Neasmith, Special Advisor

CAF J6 Functional Review

Briefing to C&E Branch Advisory Council

Dave Neasmith

23 April 2025

Canada



- Background
- The problem to solve
- Methodology
- Terminology
- Proposed role and functions
- Implementation
- Adjacent initiatives
- Next steps



- **1990s:**
 - Canadian Forces Communication Command (CFCC) disbanded as part of MCCRT and elimination of HQ
 - Defence Information Services Organization (DISO) stood up to deliver IM services by combining elements from CFCC and Automated Information Systems (AIS) from ADM (Fin)
- **“CAF J6” *informally* established 2006/2007:**
 - *Convention* agreement: then VCDS (VAdm Buck) and COS (IM) (MGen Hines).
 - Driven by need to focus IM Group on support to CAF operational requirements.
- **Original Intent:**
 - Senior GO/FO working alongside ADM (DS) (former ADM (IM)) to ensure CAF operational requirements and priorities are met
 - Reflects duality of DND/CAF - like ADM (Mat), ADM (IE).
 - “CAF J6” incumbents have tried to leverage ADM ARA, but without assigned roles, responsibilities and authorities. **Limited influence outside DSG.**
 - Dependent on “community of practice” best effort, coordinated through small J6 Coordination staff (now in CAF Cyber Command).

The Problem to Solve



- Lack of strategic coherence in aligning Joint Communications and Information Systems (JCIS) to meet CAF operational requirements and priorities.
- JCIS capabilities, services and structures are fragmented and not optimized for effective support to CAF operational requirements.
- Achieving an integrated, secure and resilient JCIS that will enable Pan-Domain Command and Control (PDC2) requires more than the current “community of interest” collaboration.
- Absence of a designated military authority to provide direction and control over JCIS capabilities and services.



- ✓ Review existing direction pertaining to “CAF J6” role
- ✓ Review relevant DND/CAF strategies, plans and programs
- ✓ Draft proposed functions that a strategic level “J6” *should* fulfill
 - ✓ Vector check with ADM (DS)/COS DSG
- ❑ **Assess where/if proposed functions are currently performed:**
 - Identify gaps, overlaps and governance mechanisms
 - Identify potential “early wins” and major “pain points”
- ❑ Draft a strategy to enable the role and functions + potential CoAs
 - ❑ Vector check with ADM (DS)/COS DSG
 - ❑ Socialize with L1s
- ❑ Seek D&G to refine strategy and implementation CoA
- ❑ Finalize strategy and implementation plan

Titles Matter: “Strategic J6/Chief Joint Signals”



- **“CAF J6” to “Strategic J6”**
 - “CAF J6” unique to other strategic “J” functions (ie. Strategic J4).
 - Align to Strategic Joint Staff (SJS) and focus on strategic role.
- **Pan-CAF role: “Chief Joint Signals”**
 - Reflects a broader, pan-CAF role to shape evolution of JCIS.
 - Direction & Guidance on “6F” Strategic Functions as they pertain to JCIS.
 - Uniformed, accountable “one dog to kick” for CAF JCIS requirements.
 - “Signals” versus “Communications” versus “Digital”
- **Joint Communications and Information System (JCIS)**
 - Many terms to describe “the combination of classified and unclassified systems and applications that enable command and control of the CAF over which rides the data and information to support CAF operations and decision-making.”
 - “JCIS” = current “community of practice” terminology.

Proposed Roles and Functions



- **Strategic Advice:** Be the principal advisor to CDS, VCDS, SJS and Operational/Environmental Commands on JCIS capabilities.
- **Readiness:** Be the authority to direct JCIS Force Elements to meet CAF Force Posture and Readiness (FP&R) requirements.
- **Direction and Guidance:** Issue (in coordination with SJS) orders and directives to control JCIS capabilities and services; Achieve CAF interoperability objectives.
- **Strategic Functions.** Lead FD of JCIS capabilities and coordinate across strategic FC, FD, FG, FE, FM and FS activities that intersect with JCIS to fulfill CAF operational requirements.
- **Alignment of Digital Program.**
 - Represent CDS/SJS at DSG governance and support ADM (DS) in aligning Product/Project implementation to meet CAF operational requirements.
 - Responsible for CAF JCIS Common Operating Picture (COP).



- **Incremental Implementation**

- CDS/DM designate a GO/FO position as “Strategic J6/Chief Joint Signals”
- Formally assign responsibilities/authorities and report lines
- Initial consolidation of DSG line and staff resources to execute some functions
- Achieve some initial “quick wins” to demonstrate value to VCDS, SJS and Operational/Environmental Commands
- “Discovery phase” to lead to subsequent implementation “spirals” and functional maturity

- **Some “Pain Points” to work on...**

- JCIS architecture and roadmap to guide FD and investment decisions
- Consolidation of requirements intake – SJ6/CJS role within DSG
- Strategic JISR “sensor to effector” connectivity, capacity and interoperability challenges
- Designating (existing) JCIS force elements and aligning to FP&R requirements (internal and external to DSG)

Adjacent Initiatives



- **VCDS/CCSI Joint Capabilities Functional Review** (ie. Possible JFC)
 - Strategic J6/Chief Joint Signals a functional component
- **SJS Defence C2 Directive**
 - C2 of CAF JCIS capabilities needs to be considered
- **Operational Sustainment Modernization (OSM)**
 - JCIS capabilities are both a component and enabler
- **CAF Cyber Command**
 - Clarify demarcation of responsibilities/authorities
- **DSG Digital Transformation and Re-alignment**
 - Aligning DSG capacities, capabilities and governance mechanisms



- **Ongoing:**
 - Refine Strategic J6/Chief Joint Signals command and staff functions in synch with adjacent functional review initiatives (previous slide)
 - Socialize and de-conflict role and functions with Operational and Environmental Commands and other L1s
- **End June 2025:** Implementation options developed
- **End-August 2025:** Implementation decision
- **End-September 2025:** Implementation Strategy and Plan



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DIGITAL SERVICES GROUP

PLACE L2 HERE (DG LEVEL)



Discussion

Canada

CAF CYBER TRAINING UNIT

PRESENTED BY DIRECTORS SIGINT

Wednesday, 23 April 2025



BRANCH OFFICE UPDATE

PRESENTED BY BRANCH ADJUTANT

Wednesday, 23 April 2025



FY24/25 UPDATE

(UPDATED 7 APRIL 2025)

- ▶ FY23/24 Carryover: \$3.5k
- ▶ MCEM Foundation: \$15k
- ▶ Budgeted: \$12.7k
- ▶ Final Cost: \$9.5k
 - ▶ Distress Fund: \$1k
 - ▶ Educational Bursary: \$1k
 - ▶ C&E Week: \$1k
 - ▶ Events and Morale: \$3k
 - ▶ CMCEN: \$3.5k
- ▶ FY24/25 Carryover: **\$9k**

FY25/26 DEMAND

(UPDATED 8 APRIL 2025)

- ▶ FY24/25 Carryover: \$9k
- ▶ MCEM Foundation: \$10k
- ▶ **Total Funds: \$19k**
- ▶ **Planned (\$19k)**
 - ▶ Distress Fund: \$1k
 - ▶ Educational Bursary: \$5k
 - ▶ C&E Week: \$3.5k
 - ▶ Events and Morale: \$5.5k
 - ▶ CMCEN: \$0.5k
 - ▶ Misc: \$3.5k

C&E Week

Ex NOBLE SKYWAVE - \$500
Regional PD/Super Jimmy - \$2k
Jr Ranks Dinner - \$500
Misc - \$500

Events/Morale

April: Winter BAC - \$0
April: Spring Senate - \$0
May: NCR All Ranks Mess Dinner (CFS Leitrim - TBC) - \$0
June: NCR Golf (CJOC HQ) - \$500
August: Kingston Golf (77 LR) - \$500
August: Regional Golf (West – 1 Sigs) - \$500
September: Fall BAC - \$0
Sep/Oct: Capture the Flag (CFNOC – TBC) - \$500
October: Fall Senate - \$0
January: NCR Bonspiel (TBC) - \$500
February: Winter BAC - \$0
February: Kingston Bonspiel (TBC) - \$500
February: Regional Bonspiel (Atl – 12 Wing CIS Flt) - \$500
March: WiDS - \$1k
March: Ex COMM PLAYER (TBC) - \$500

RECOMMENDATION - EDUCATIONAL BURSARY -> MICRO-BURSARY FOR SERVING MBRS

- ▶ Issue: Jr ranks see limited ROI from the Branch resulting in no additional P070 pay allotments in 2024 (limited prior to 2024).
- ▶ Limited benefit to new/junior members for Branch program with most funding
- ▶ Recommendation: ***Change*** Increase #/reduce \$ from 5 x \$1,000 bursaries to 20 x \$250 bursaries
- ▶ Criteria: Member (contributing), request pre-enrolment, university/college/technical course eligible, reimbursement of lowest amount (course cost or \$250) upon proof of completion
- ▶ Historical awarding of Educational Bursary (dependents of, unless indicated):
 - ▶ 2024: 1 x LCol
 - ▶ 2023: 3 x MWO, 1 x WO (retd)
 - ▶ 2022: 1 x MWO
 - ▶ 2021: 1 x MCpl
 - ▶ 2020: 1 x Maj, 1 x Capt, 1 x MWO, 1 x MWO (retd), 2 x WO
 - ▶ 2019: 2 x BGen, 2 x Maj
 - ▶ 2018: 1 x LCol, 1 x Maj, 1 x CPO2, 1 x Cpl (mbr rx'd)
- ▶ See Proposed Instruction

UPCOMING TIMELINES

- ▶ *Branch Educational Bursary Solicitation*
- ▶ Branch Subaltern of the Year / Member of the Year
 - ▶ Solicitation email sent
 - ▶ Nominations due to Branch Adjutant **20 June 2025**
 - ▶ Selection board **25 June 2025**
- ▶ Solicitation for Col-in-Chief Commendation and Heritage Award sent
- ▶ Letter to HRH to be sent on **7 June 2025** (Anniversary of HRH becoming Col-in-Chief of C&E Branch)
- ▶ NCR C&E Mess Dinner - **6 June 2025** @ CFS Leitrim ARM - TBC
 - ▶ PMC - Maj Brody Peddle (CFS Leitrim)
 - ▶ VPMC - WO Jimmy Genest (R&CS)
- ▶ ROSEN Dinner - **13 June 2025** @ VOM (OPI - Mr Steve Saunier)

OPEN FORUM ROUND TABLE QUESTION PERIOD CLOSING REMARKS

Branch Leader / All

